

# Stephen Martinez

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## Professional Summary

21 years in Product/Design, most of it spent on systems other teams depend on. Comfortable leading technical decisions, pushing back on scope when it matters, and carrying a pager for what I build. Primary tools: Figma and Looker.

## Career Highlights

- Ran discovery interviews with 10 customers, reshaping the following year's roadmap.
- Built the experimentation framework the team uses to size bets before committing.
- Prototyped 4 concepts in TypeScript and killed two early on evidence rather than opinion.

## Education and Training

### Bachelor, Business Administration

Universidad Politecnica de Madrid | 2001 – 2004

## Professional Experience

### IBM — Staff Product Manager

Oct 2019 – Current

- Defined north-star metrics and instrumented them across 3 delivery squads.
- Reduced support contacts by 18% by reworking the checkout and error states.
- Prioritised a backlog for 50 engineers, delivering 3 releases per quarter.
- Negotiated scope with engineering and legal to ship a compliance deadline on time.

### Senior Product Designer, Clearwater Systems

Feb 2015 – Sep 2019

- Introduced accessibility standards to the design process, taking 30 flows to WCAG AA.
- Shipped a design system in Sketch adopted across 5 product surfaces.
- Facilitated usability testing that surfaced 30 critical friction points before launch.

### Technical Product Manager

SAP | Sep 2010 – Jan 2015

- Redesigned onboarding in Figma, lifting activation from 40% to 94%.
- Wrote the PRDs and acceptance criteria for a platform migration affecting 10k users.

### UX Designer, Harbor Point Tech

May 2006 – Jul 2010

- Partnered with data to define activation and retention definitions the whole company now uses.
- Ran quarterly roadmap reviews with executive stakeholders and published the trade-offs openly.

### Product Manager, Adobe

May 2004 – Dec 2005

- Introduced written design docs and an RFC process, cutting rework late in delivery.
- Managed stakeholder communication during a major incident, including the post-mortem.

## Technologies

**Languages:** SQL, TypeScript, Scala

**Frameworks:** React, FastAPI

**Cloud & DevOps:** Azure

**Data:** MySQL

**Analytics & Design:** Figma, Looker, Excel, Power BI, Sketch, Tableau

**Testing & Tooling:** Jira, Confluence, Git

## Projects

### **Recipe search engine**

Full-text search over a scraped recipe corpus using Looker; learned more about ranking than about cooking.

### **Commute optimiser**

Pulls transit APIs and suggests departure times, built on SQL.

### **Certificates**

Professional Data Engineer — Google Cloud, 2023

Databricks Certified Data Engineer Associate — Databricks, 2026

### **Community**

STEM ambassador running school workshops twice a term.

### **Interests**

Bouldering, Five-a-side football, Rock climbing